Maybe this is home

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/52207999.

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General Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Angella & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Catra, angella, Glimmer

Additional Tags:
Angst at some points, A little bit of fluff, Some sweet Momgella, based on the amazing story by ResFlower, I guess you could say it's kind of like prequel?, I have no authority though, I just wrote this because I was craving Angella Momming the hell out of Catra, Mentions of Shadow Weaver being the worst parent, Mentions of past Glitra and a VERY bad breakup, Catra goes to therapy!, it's great

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Maybe this is home

by catrasredemption (dimensionhoppingrose)

Summary

"*Hello?*"

Catra's breath caught, and she couldn't speak. She hadn't even said *goodbye* to Angella and Micah, mostly because she hadn't wanted them to tear her down for hurting their daughter, like Glimmer wasn't *also* at fault for everything that happened. But of course they would take her side. Glimmer was their *actual* daughter. Catra was just a stray who had followed Glimmer home and looked pathetic enough to keep.

"*Catra?*"

-OR-

A small prequel to *Secrets Are the Enemy of Intimacy* by ResFlower, in which Catra struggles with a simple therapy assignment - to reach out and reconnect with the one person she could almost call her mother.

Notes

I was just too inspired. Blame ResFlower for being an amazing writer.

See the end of the work for more notes

- Inspired by Secrets Are the Enemy of Intimacy by ResFlower
- Inspired by Secrets Are the Enemy of Intimacy by ResFlower

Angella leans forward, irritation clear in her expression. "I just want to hear your side of whatever this is Catra. I don't want you to feel like you can't come to me."

Like last time remains *unsaid but Angella might as well have shouted it. It took years for Catra to reach out to Angella again—it had actually been a therapy assignment. She's not sure she would have had the courage to do it otherwise. She's so glad she did. —* Secrets Are the Enemy of Intimacy, Ch. 12

A lot of things had happened in Catra's life to lead her to where she was — sitting on the floor of her bedroom in the apartment she shared with three other people, holding her phone as gingerly as she would hold a live grenade. She had purged her life of anything related to *Glimmer Moon* after The Breakup, and that had very much included Glimmer's *parents*. She had deleted their phone numbers from her phone, but she couldn't erase them from her head. Nothing was really *safe* in her phone. Weaver had taught her that.

Reach out to Angella. It was such a simple assignment. And then what? Who knew. The therapist had suggested maybe closure, or to re-connect with the life she had abandoned after everything that had happened. Catra wasn't sure which one of those she wanted *less*.

She tapped Angella's number into her phone, took a deep breath, and hit *call*.

Three rings. "*Hello?*"

Catra ended the call. Tomorrow. She could try again tomorrow.

The next day she was sitting on her bed, still staring at her phone like it might explode. *Just dial the number. Stop being such a*

coward about this. Just make the call.

She tapped in the number, hit call, and put the phone to her ear. It rang and rang and rang…

"*Hello?*"

Catra's breath caught, and she couldn't speak. She hadn't even said *goodbye* to Angella and Micah, mostly because she hadn't wanted them to tear her down for hurting their daughter, like Glimmer wasn't *also* at fault for everything that happened. But of course they would take her side. Glimmer was their *actual* daughter. Catra was just a stray who had followed Glimmer home and looked pathetic enough to keep.

"*Catra?"*

What the *fuck*? Catra ripped the phone from her ear and smashed the end call button. How had Angella known? She couldn't have. Catra had changed her number six months after The Breakup so she didn't have to worry about Angella and Micah getting around the fact that she blocked their numbers. She couldn't have known. It was just a guess.

But why would Angella think of *her*?

"Have you reached out to Angella?"

Catra kept her eyes on the shelf to her right. Her therapist kept a lot of fidget toys for people who needed them while they talked. Catra was *not* one of those people. She just bounced her leg as she spoke. "Um… yeah. I called."

Her therapist raised an eyebrow. "And? What did she say?"

"Well… nothing, really. I hung up on her."

"Why did you feel the need to lie about it?"

"It wasn't technically a lie," Catra bit back irritably. "I said I called. And I did. Twice."

The therapist was quiet for a moment, letting Catra chase things around in her head before she finally sighed, eyes falling to the floor. "She asked if it was me the second time I called, and I hung up. I panicked."

"What are you afraid of?"

Catra bit back a defensive *I'm not scared of anything*, and tried to really think about the question. What was she afraid of? It was a shockingly easy answer. "That Angella's going to hate me for hurting her daughter." She never said Glimmer's name out loud if she could help it. It always felt as if someone was shoving a hot poker through a barely healed hole in her chest. "That she's going to tell me to never call her again, and that she can't believe she ever trusted me, and… and that she's disappointed in me."

Tears were filling her eyes now. That was humiliating. "That's understandable. I know she's very important to you."

"She was my mom." Catra was horrified to hear her own voice cracking. "It really felt like she loved me sometimes. I'm sure she was just being nice because of Glimmer, but it… it felt good."

"And you're worried those memories will be tainted if she rejects you now?" Catra nodded, dragging the back of her hand across her eyes. "But you haven't given her a chance. And even if it's the worse-case scenario… isn't it better to know than to wonder for the rest of your life?"

Would it be? Probably. Catra could recover from being hurt. She was resilient. She survived and she moved on. But never knowing would eat away at her mind for the rest of her life.

Back on the floor, curled into a corner, the way she had when she didn't want to give Weaver a chance to catch her off-guard. She

tapped the familiar number into her phone and pressed the call button before putting the phone to her ear.

It rang once, and then again, and—

"*Hello?*"

Catra had really been depending on that third ring, she realized as Angella's sudden answer threw her off. Still, she coughed to clear her throat and said, "Um… h-hi, Angella. It's Catra." Her voice wobbled dangerously on every word. Angella let out her own breath.

"*Catra*." Her tone was impossible to read. But the sound of it broke something in Catra's chest; she curled in on herself, pressing her forehead against her knees, and burst into tears. "*Catra?*" Now Angella sounded alarmed and concerned. "*What's wrong, honey? Are you in trouble?*"

"N-No," Catra managed to say, wiping her eyes with her sleeve. God, this was so stupid. She could have a conversation with turning into a blubbering mess, couldn't she? "It's not… I'm not in trouble. I just wanted to uh… to say hello. And say I'm sorry for not calling sooner."

"*You've nothing to apologize for, dear*," Angella assured her gently. "*I'm glad you called*."

The shock of the statement shook Catra out of her head a little. "You are?"

"*Of course. I've been so worried about you, and no one seemed to know where you had gone after you graduated from BMU. Are you okay? Are you somewhere safe?*"

"Yeah. I'm uh… going to FZ for grad school. Living off campus in a way too expensive apartment with too many roommates, but I can afford the rent and what not."

"*You're going to grad school!*" Angella sounded positively delighted. "*I'm so happy for you. I know you had so many plans. Glimmer decided to take a break after finishing undergrad, but I'm not sure she's ever really planning to go back and finish*."

Hearing Glimmer's name thrown around so casually was like having icy water poured over her. Catra struggled to speak through the sudden stranglehold on her throat. "I don't… want to talk about Glimmer. Please?"

Angella was silent for a moment, and Catra was sure she had ruined everything. "*I understand, dear. I'm sorry, I should have known better.*"

"No, it's — it's fine." Catra pinched the bridge of her nose. "I just… want to talk to you. About anything else. How's Micah?"

"*Micah? You mean the man who used to call himself my husband? He appears to have flown the coop just like the rest of my family*."

Catra laughed, hoping desperately this was just a joke. "Where'd he go?"

"*He's been moving between here and Beast Island for awhile now. We've discussed the topic at length, and as much as it pains me to have him so far away, I know he's following his dream.*"

A small smile pulled at Catra's lips. Angella and Micah had always been relationship goals to her. They obviously loved each other as much now as they did the day they were married. And they were solid enough that Micah could apparently just disappear to some old island for months on end and Angella's only complaint was a joke that he had left her.

"I hope he comes home soon."

"*As do I. But you know what might make up for his absence in the mean time?*"

"What's that?"

"*If someone else I haven't seen in a long time comes to visit*."

Catra scoffed, trying to cover up how her heart had started pounding. "That's low, Angella."

"*I use whatever advantages I have. What are you doing next weekend?*"

It wasn't a particularly convenient drive, but Catra was willing to do it just this once so Angella could see that she was alive. Angella had *promised* that Glimmer wouldn't be there, that she'd almost immediately moved in with Bow after college — and Catra didn't want to think too hard about why *that* bothered her — and that it would be just the two of them.

The thought of that made Catra feel a slightly selfish spark of joy. *Just the two of them*. She had shared *everything* with Glimmer, and that wasn't even Glimmer's fault, not really. It was *her* life, her friends, her Bow, her parents. Catra was just a parasite who had latched on to it and pretended it was hers.

But damn was that easy to forget when Angella opened the door and beamed at Catra as if she were her long-lost daughter. "It's so good to see you," she said as she swept Catra up into a hug. Catra… hadn't been expecting this kind of reaction. Sure, Angella had wanted to see her, but being *this* happy about it? What kind of mother loved their daughter's horrible, terrible ex?

"Catra?" Apparently she had been still for too long. Angella pulled back, hands still on her shoulders, searching her expression. "Was that too forward? Why are you crying?"

Huh. She was indeed crying. Again. "It's… It's nothing," Catra said quickly, wiping her eyes. "I'm just really happy to see you."

Angella softened, smiling. "I'm happy to see you too, dear. Come in. I've set up everything for tea."

"Oh — I brought you something," Catra said, holding up the bag she had almost forgotten. "It's not much, I know you have a million teapots, but there's this cute place near my apartment and this one made me think of you…"

They sat, and Angella took her present, opening it curiously. It was a black, cast iron teapot with birds outlined in gold carved into the side. "It's *gorgeous*," she murmured, turning it in her hands. "I may have to visit this shop when I come to see your apartment."

"Wait, what?"

"Tell me more about grad school." Angella transitioned the topic so smoothly that Catra was almost fooled into thinking she had been hearing things. But Angella was impossible to argue with, and Catra really didn't want to, anyway.

So she told Angella about her life. She talked about the classes she was taking, the new friends she had made, and even the cat she had been thinking about getting.

"His name is Melog," Catra said, showing Angella a picture on her phone. "He's been at the shelter every time I've visited. The workers there said that kittens usually go fast, but Melog is… feisty."

"Feisty," Angella repeated, amused. "I can think of someone that would also apply to."

"Yeah, yeah. He just doesn't seem to like other people, mostly? But the first time he was out of his cage around me, he tried to climb my sleeve."

Angella laughed. "He sounds rather pushy."

"But only with me! The last time I was there to see him, one of the workers said he's started tucking himself back into a corner and hissing every time someone comes around to see him."

"He's already decided you're his home, clearly. What's stopping you from adopting him?"

"I mean…" Catra sighed, tucking her phone away. "I'm not exactly rolling in cash right now. I work at the campus bookstore part time, and I make enough rent, but animals come with a ton of expenses. And starting out is worse. I'd have to get all the supplies at once — you know, litter box, food, bowls, and so on — *and* I have to take him to the very to get him fixed and make sure he's up to date on his shots. And kittens get extra shots because they're kittens and need to be vaccinated against things. So I don't know if I can really afford it. But I *do* want him…"

"Well, you tend to find a way to get the things you want," Angella said with a fond smile, stirring her tea. Catra smiled back.

"Yeah. I hope so."

Angella tried very hard to get Catra to stay later and spend the night. But Catra would rather drive all night than risk Glimmer dropping in to visit and finding her there.

"Call me when you get home," Angella insisted as she handed Catra a couple of steamers full of dumplings.

"I will." Catra hesitated before adjusting the steamers in one arm and holding her other arm out for a hug. Angella happily obliged.

"And stay in touch. Please."

"I will," Catra assured her. "I promise."

And she meant it, she realized as she sat down in her car and made sure the steamers were secure for the drive back to her apartment. She had missed Angella *so much*. The woman had basically been her mother for her teen years — more of a parental figure than Weaver had ever been, certainly. And she had let all of that fall away in fear of facing what Angella would think of The Breakup, and her part in it — although it sounded like Glimmer

had told her surprisingly little about any of it. Good. Maybe she realized it actually *was* her fault as much as it was Catra's.

Catra got about halfway home before the smell of the dumplings became too irresistible. She'd just have one, she reasoned as she pulled into a gas station, picking up the top steamer… and seeing an envelope taped to the bottom one. She tilted her head, curious, and reached out to grab it.

Inside was a check for an amount of money that made Catra want to die on the spot. And a note.

Catra,

Don't argue. Consider this a make up for all the birthdays and holidays I missed. And get your cat.

Love,

Angella

Catra didn't know whether to laugh or cry. She settled for both.

"Glimmer!" Angella called from the porch. "Can you get my phone for me while you're in there? Your father is supposed to call soon."

"Sure," Glimmer called back. She finished pouring her drink, then went to get Angella's phone off the counter. The screen lit up as she picked it up, and she saw there was a text on the screen. She almost didn't look — it was probably just her dad — but the name caught her eye. And her glass slipped from her hands, shattering on the floor.

"Glimmer?" Angella sounded concerned. "What's—?"

She was cut off by Glimmer surging out the back door, her expression absolutely livid. "Why is *Catra* texting you?" she demanded, all but throwing the phone at her mother. Angella caught it, giving Glimmer a hard stare.

"Because I asked her to stay in touch. She got back in contact with me a few weeks ago."

"*Why* would you ask her to do that?! Why are you even *talking* to her?!"

Angella stood, towering over her daughter, her expression stony. "Because she lived under my roof for years, even if it wasn't full time, and I've been worried sick about her since she disappeared."

"*I'm* your daughter! You're supposed to be on my side!"

"I *am* on your side, Glimmer. But you won't tell me what happened, and neither would Catra, and as such I have no reason to believe Catra doesn't deserve just as much support as what I've given you."

"But… But she… I…" Glimmer stuttered before letting a wordless, high-pitched noise. "I can't believe you!"

"Are you going to tell me about the break up?" Glimmer's eye twitched, but she didn't answer. "I *am* capable of loving you both, you know."

"This is *just* like her," Glimmer fumed. "I can't have *anything*, she always has to take it—"

"*Glimmer*." Angella's voice was firm as she cut Glimmer off. "Everything Catra had was something *you* shared with her, and that includes your father and I. She didn't deserve to lose it all because of whatever happened between you two.

"I will not make you see each other. I won't try to trick you into standing in the same room or talking. I'm sorry you found out by seeing something from her on my phone, but I will *not* abandon her on your word alone. Do you understand?"

No, Glimmer did *not* understand. But she knew nothing would sway her mother. Instead, Glimmer turned to storm back into the

kitchen and clean up the mess she'd made.

Angella watched her go, sighing, and finally looked at the message that riled Glimmer up. It was a picture of a gray kitten, walking around on a bed.

Catra: *This is Melog!*

Angella smiled despite herself. She knew she should have spoken to Glimmer about it, and she had been planning on it — maybe with Bow present. But she stood by what she said. Catra needed her support, and Angella would give it to her, however she could. She wouldn't see Catra turned away again, whether it was by Glimmer or her own choice.

End Notes

A few notes!

1) As of posting this on 12/12/2023, Secrets has been posted up to Ch. 16, and no, we still don't know the reason for the Glitra breakup, just that it was extremely messy and they very much want nothing to do with each other.

2) This is set roughly... five years? before the start of Secrets, so Catra's not as cool and put together as she is in the main story. She's still in her Therapy era.

3) Yes as usual Glimmer comes off extremely petty and maybe a little cruel at the end - seems to be a trend in my fics - but honestly, that's not much different from how she is in the main fic, where she spends a lot of time ranting about Catra daring to exist and reacting very poorly to finding out Adora is dating Catra. And that's not to say Catra is much better! She doesn't insult Glimmer, but the first time they see each other, she's openly hostile and purposely riles Glimmer up. She just tends to be more of the "let it fester inside" type.

4) A lot of this is my own interpretation of the story (some of it discussed with Res, some not), and again, should not be taken as an official part of the source material. Res is just cool enough to let me play in their sandbox.

5) Fun fact! - this is the first She-Ra story I've ever written where Adora just doesn't exist. Not even an allusion to her. This is also the first story that hasn't had any Catradora in it. I'm shocked too.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!